SJR 9
FISCAL NOTE

Fiscal Review Committee
Tennessee General Assembly

January 16, 2025

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SUMMARY OF BILL: Proposes amending Article I, Section 35 of the Constitution of Tennessee to expand the rights of victims of crime. Requires the amendment be submitted to the people in the November 2026 general election.

FISCAL IMPACT:

LOCAL GOVERNMENT	
EXPENDITURES	**Mandatory**
FY26-27	$9,400
Article II, Section 24 of the Tennessee Constitution provides that: no law of general application shall impose increased expenditure requirements on cities or counties unless the General Assembly shall provide that the state share in the cost.	

Assumptions:

- Pursuant to Article XI, Section 3 of the Constitution of Tennessee, following passage by two successive General Assemblies, the proposed amendatory language is submitted to the people for a vote at the next general election in which a Governor is to be chosen.
- The proposed constitutional amendment language received its first General Assembly passage with House Joint Resolution 94 on February 26, 2024.
- Pursuant to Tenn. Code Ann. § 2-5-211(b), at least five days before the beginning of early voting, the county election commission shall either publish a sample ballot in a newspaper of general circulation or mail the sample ballot to every active registered voter.
- The requirement to add this constitutional amendment to the 2026 general election ballot will increase the size of the sample ballot to be published and subsequently increase printing costs.
- The one-time increase in local expenditures in FY26-27 for publishing costs is estimated to be $9,400, based upon the cost of recent publications incurred by the Secretary of State.

CERTIFICATION:

The information contained herein is true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Bojan Savic

Bojan Savic, Executive Director